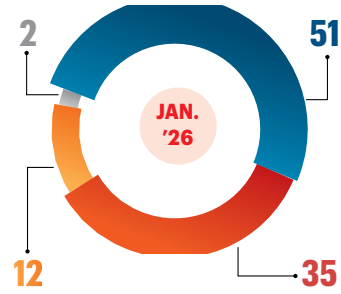
"all-weather friend", remains work in progress. India's Neighbourhood First policy has thus prioritised outcome-linked assistance, which has met with approval in the INDIA TODAY Mood of the Nation (MOTN) January 2026 poll—51 per cent of the respondents believe India's ties with neighbours have improved under Prime Minister Narendra Modi, while 34 per cent say they have deteriorated.

At a juncture when the global world order is in flux, the NDA government has stepped up its strategic assertiveness—ties with Japan and the European Union have deepened, and there are meaningful engagements with the G20 and BRICS. However, fewer MOTN respondents approve of India's foreign policy as a whole under the NDA government: a healthy 60 per cent believe it has strengthened India's global standing, but the endorsement has come down from 66.7 per cent in August 2025 and 72.6 per cent in February 2025. Those with a negative view have risen to over 30 per cent



Q. Have India's relations with its neighbouring countries improved or deteriorated under Prime Minister Narendra Modi?



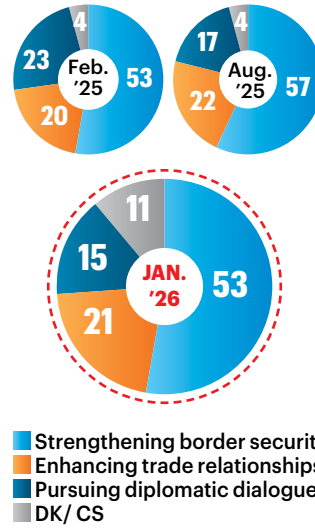
A thumbs up for India's neighbourhood policy, but a large minority disagrees

Q. Has the Indian government responded well to the atrocities against minorities in Bangladesh?

Yes, the government's response has been adequate	25
No, the government should take stronger measures	47
Partly yes, but the government must raise global pressure	18
DK/ CS	10

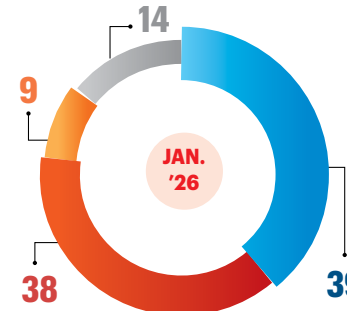
Almost half of respondents aren't happy with India's firm but moderate approach

Q. What should be India's priority in managing its relationship with China?



Security along the LAC has been a steady concern vis-a-vis ties with China

Q. Has the Indian government effectively countered US president Donald Trump's repeated claims that he brokered peace during Op. Sindoor?



India's low-key but firm denial of Trump's claim has respondents divided

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS: Don't know/ can't say